

# ROLL-OFF CONTAINER MANUFACTURING PLANT (GEORGIA / USA) — INVESTOR REPORT

## Phased Production Roadmap (Phase 1 → Phase 2 → Phase 3)

**Date:** August 2026 · **Currency:** All values are in US Dollars (\$) unless otherwise stated. **Scope:** Adaptation of the Turkey model (30 m<sup>3</sup> heavy-duty roll-off container, three-phase phased production) to Georgia state market conditions. **Document:** Investment decision support document — all figures are estimates based on August 2026 US/Georgia market data.

## 1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This project establishes a manufacturing plant for **30 m<sup>3</sup> (= ~39.2 yd<sup>3</sup>, matching the US standard 40 yd<sup>3</sup> class) heavy-duty roll-off containers** (6,000 × 2,500 × 2,200 mm, open top, hook bar, slide rails). Production is built not in one go but in a **three-phase phased model**: each phase is financed from its own revenue, and every stage has a clear "go/no-go" decision gate. The model structure is identical to the Turkey report; only price, cost, tax and labor data reflect the Georgia/US market.

| Metric                              | Value (base case)                           |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| Total investment (3 phases)         | <b>\$3.37 million</b>                       |
| Phase 1 investment                  | <b>\$1.30 million</b>                       |
| Year 1 unit sales                   | 268 units                                   |
| Year 3 unit sales                   | 650 units                                   |
| Unit production cost (Phase 1)      | ~\$12,354                                   |
| Average selling price               | \$14,500 → \$15,800 (entry → normalization) |
| Annual EBITDA (Y1 / Y2 / Y3)        | <b>\$0.65M / \$1.74M / \$3.45M</b>          |
| EBITDA margin                       | ~17% (entry) → ~34% (Y3)                    |
| Simple payback                      | <b>~4 years</b> (from production start)     |
| Cumulative free cash flow (3 years) | <b>+\$1.0M (~28% of investment)</b>         |
| Cumulative cash return (5 years)    | <b>~2.0× investment</b>                     |

**Why this product?** Roll-off containers serve the construction, excavation, municipal and industrial waste markets with steady demand — low-technology but high-value-added products. Production in Georgia competes with national manufacturers (Wastequip, Galbreath, Perkins) on **short lead time, customization, on-site warranty and regional logistics advantage**. Freight per container is high in the US; a regional producer beats national competitors' "factory + freight" offers.

**Market entry strategy (price):** Enter at **\$14,500**, ~13% below regional competitors; growth comes from volume. Price normalizes to \$15,000 in Y2 and \$15,800 in Y3. With ~\$12,083 unit cash cost, entry margin is ~17%; scale + automation push it to ~34% by Y3.

**Georgia vs Turkey:** The same business model in the US produces a longer payback (~4 years) due to higher labor, rent and insurance costs, no customs protection and strong national competition. In return: a deeper market, export via the Port of Savannah (Caribbean, Central America, Canada) and large-scale construction/excavation demand.

## 2. PRODUCT — TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

| Parameter            | Value                                                                      |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Volume               | ~30 m <sup>3</sup> (= ~39.2 yd <sup>3</sup> → US 40 yd <sup>3</sup> class) |
| External dimensions  | 6,000 × 2,500 × 2,200 mm (~19'8" × 8'2" × 7'3")                            |
| Top                  | Open (hook loading)                                                        |
| Floor plate          | 6 mm (5–8 mm range)                                                        |
| Wall plate           | 4 mm (3–5 mm range)                                                        |
| Chassis (skid) rails | 2 × IPE 160 (I-section)                                                    |
| Cross beams          | 7 pcs, U 100 / box 80×80×4                                                 |
| Corner posts         | Box 80×80×4                                                                |
| Intermediate posts   | Box 60×60×3                                                                |
| Hook bar             | Ø 50 mm solid steel + welded ears                                          |
| Rear door            | Optional double-leaf, hinged                                               |
| Surface              | Shot blasting + 2K epoxy/polyurethane paint                                |
| Container weight     | ~3,200 kg steel                                                            |

**Design approach:** Plates and sections are sourced **cut/bent** from an external supplier (Phase 1); welding and assembly are done in-house. Plates are handled with gantry cranes, sections with crane-assisted placement (robot-assisted in Phase 3); during welding the container is rotated with positioner/rollover fixtures. Hooklift compatibility is modeled to US standards (hook type: Galbreath/Perkins compatible, skid length and hook opening).

## 3. MACRO ASSUMPTIONS (AUGUST 2026 — US / GEORGIA)

| Item                                   | Value                                                                                                |
|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Corporate income tax                   | Federal 21% + Georgia state 4.99% → <b>effective ~25%</b> (state tax deducted from the federal base) |
| Sales tax                              | Georgia 4% (exemptions for manufacturing inputs and production equipment)                            |
| Minimum wage (federal = Georgia)       | \$7.25/hour                                                                                          |
| Skilled welder/fitter wage             | ~\$23/hour                                                                                           |
| Welder/fitter <b>fully loaded cost</b> | ~\$30/hour (incl. employer taxes + benefits)                                                         |
| Steel plate (A36, hot-rolled)          | ~\$1,200/short ton (~\$1,320/metric ton)                                                             |

| Item                                         | Value                                        |
|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Steel sections                               | ~\$1,350/short ton                           |
| Scrap recovery price                         | ~\$375/short ton                             |
| Factory rent (secondary location, NNN incl.) | ~\$5.50/sq ft/yr (~\$59/m <sup>2</sup> /yr)  |
| Energy                                       | ~\$0.13/kWh                                  |
| Workers' comp + product liability insurance  | High premium for welding (~8–12% of payroll) |

Note: Steel prices fluctuate monthly in the US; the model is tested in the sensitivity table (see Section 8). A 3,500 m<sup>2</sup> plant ≈ 37,700 sq ft.

## 4. PRODUCTION STRATEGY — THREE-PHASE ROADMAP

The model is not one big investment but **three independent phases**. Each phase finances the next from its own revenue, and each phase ends with a clear **decision gate**: if the condition is not met, no further investment is made and the operation is downsized and continued. Phases align to years — the investor sees at a glance what was spent in each phase and what revenue was generated up to that point.

### Phase comparison

|                | Phase 1                             | Phase 2                     | Phase 3                  |
|----------------|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| Timing         | Year 1 (months 1–12)                | Year 2 (months 13–24)       | Year 3 (months 25–36)    |
| Capacity       | 15–20 → 40 units/month              | 45 units/month              | 55–60 units/month        |
| Staff          | 15 (9 direct / 6 indirect)          | 20 (12 / 8)                 | 19 (10 / 9)              |
| Unit cash cost | ~\$12,083                           | ~\$11,520                   | ~\$10,500                |
| Key change     | Manual welding + outsourced cutting | CNC plasma brought in-house | Robotic welding deployed |

### Phase 1 — Year 1 (months 1–12): start with low investment

- **Investment:** \$1.30M — workshop fit-out, gantry cranes (2 × 5 t), 2 welding stations (MIG/MAG), paint booth, portable cutting kit (~\$20K), fixtures/jigs, initial stock.
- **Method / what changes:** Cutting and bending are done **at an external supplier** (no capital needed); in-house manual welding + assembly. Production starts at 15–20 units/month and ramps to ~36–40 by year-end. Building the customer portfolio realistically takes ~1 year; initially no staff is hired for 40 units/month (4 welders, 1 salesperson).
- **Objective:** Validate demand with real sales, learn the operation, build a customer/hook-type database.

### Financial picture up to this point (end of Year 1):

| Item    | Value                          |
|---------|--------------------------------|
| Revenue | \$3.89M (268 units × \$14,500) |
| EBITDA  | \$0.65M (16.7%)                |

| Item                                            | Value           |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Cumulative investment (capex + working capital) | \$1.30M         |
| <b>Cumulative free cash flow</b>                | <b>−\$0.78M</b> |

**Decision gate 1 (month 12):** Sustainable sales  $\geq$  **30 units/month** (ramp-end ~36) → proceed to Phase 2.  
Otherwise: reduce capacity, no further investment.

### Phase 2 — Year 2 (months 13–24): bring CNC plasma cutting in-house

- **Investment:** +\$0.35M — CNC plasma + gas infrastructure (payback ~9 months).
- **What changes:** External cutting dependency **ends**; lead time shortens, unit cash cost drops from ~\$12,083 to ~\$11,520. Capacity rises to 45 units/month; welders 4 → 6, staff 20.

#### Financial picture (end of Year 2):

| Item                             | Value                  |
|----------------------------------|------------------------|
| Cumulative revenue               | \$11.39M (3.89 + 7.50) |
| Cumulative EBITDA                | \$2.39M                |
| Cumulative investment            | \$1.65M                |
| <b>Cumulative free cash flow</b> | <b>+\$0.22M</b>        |

**Decision gate 2 (month 24):** Sustainable sales  $\geq$  **45 units/month** → Phase 3.

### Phase 3 — Year 3 (months 25–36): welding robots and automation

- **Investment:** +\$1.72M → **total \$3.37M** (\$1.30M + \$0.35M + \$1.72M)
- 6 × 6-DOF welding robots: \$0.68M; EOAT/section gripper + automatic torch changer (in-house design, material): \$0.04M → subtotal \$0.72M
- Positioner/rollover fixtures (chassis turner, body rollover, door positioner, synchronized): \$0.35M
- Jigs/locating fixtures: \$0.12M
- Commissioning, training, contingency: \$0.53M
- **What changes:** Robots take over welding labor → welders 6 → 2; one **robot operator** and a welding engineer are added (staff 20 → 19). Unit cash cost drops to ~\$10,500, capacity rises to 55–60 units/month; consistent weld quality and resilience to the US welder shortage.

#### Financial picture (end of Year 3):

| Item                             | Value                               |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Cumulative revenue               | \$21.66M                            |
| Cumulative EBITDA                | \$5.83M                             |
| Cumulative investment            | \$3.37M                             |
| <b>Cumulative free cash flow</b> | <b>+\$1.0M (~28% of investment)</b> |

**Why phased?** Robots create a depreciation burden at low volume (one-off full automation can cost more than manual at low sales). Each phase is financed from its own cash flow; the investor has no one-time sunk-risk exposure.

## Investment breakdown (total \$3.37M)

| Item                                                                  | Investment (\$M) |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| Building fit-out + gantry cranes (2 × 5 t)                            | 0.28             |
| Welding stations (2 × MIG/MAG + fume extraction) + gas infrastructure | 0.20             |
| CNC plasma (Phase 2)                                                  | 0.35             |
| 6 welding robots + EOAT/torch changer (in-house design)               | 0.72             |
| Positioner/rollover fixtures                                          | 0.35             |
| Jigs / locating fixtures                                              | 0.12             |
| Paint booth + surface preparation                                     | 0.14             |
| Portable cutting kit                                                  | 0.02             |
| Measurement/test/quality equipment                                    | 0.09             |
| Initial stock + working capital                                       | 0.57             |
| Installation, training, commissioning                                 | 0.35             |
| Contingency                                                           | 0.18             |
| <b>TOTAL</b>                                                          | <b>3.37</b>      |

## 5. UNIT COST STRUCTURE (PHASE 1, STEADY 40 UNITS/MONTH)

| Item                                                           | \$/unit (40 units/month) |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Plate (2,950 kg ≈ 3.25 short tons × \$1,200/st)                | \$3,900                  |
| Sections (900 kg ≈ 0.99 short tons × \$1,350/st)               | \$1,337                  |
| Scrap recovery (−380 kg ≈ 0.42 st × \$375)                     | −\$157                   |
| External cutting + bending                                     | \$950                    |
| Welding consumables / gas                                      | \$145                    |
| Paint (2K)                                                     | \$210                    |
| Hardware (hook, latch, hinges, door set, skid liners)          | \$320                    |
| Other consumables                                              | \$110                    |
| <b>Materials subtotal</b>                                      | <b>\$6,815</b>           |
| Direct labor (9 people, 40 units/month; ~\$30/hr fully loaded) | \$1,168                  |
| Indirect labor (6 people)                                      | \$675                    |
| Management/technical staff                                     | \$463                    |
| Rent (37,700 sq ft × \$5.50/yr / 12 / 40)                      | \$432                    |
| Energy / gas                                                   | \$325                    |
| Overhead, quality, insurance (incl. workers' comp)             | \$440                    |
| Logistics                                                      | \$290                    |

| Item                                        | \$/unit (40 units/month) |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Sales & warranty provision (~4% × \$14,500) | \$580                    |
| Working capital interest                    | \$90                     |
| Maintenance / repairs                       | \$155                    |
| Rework / scrap                              | \$190                    |
| Central / general admin charge              | \$460                    |
| <b>Operating expenses subtotal</b>          | <b>\$5,268</b>           |
| Depreciation (\$1.30M / 10 yr / 12 / 40)    | \$271                    |
| <b>TOTAL UNIT COST</b>                      | <b>≈ \$12,354</b>        |

**Cost evolution:** Phase 1 ~\$12,354 → Phase 2 ~\$11,885 → Phase 3 ~\$11,050 (full cost; cash cost ~\$12,083 / ~\$11,520 / ~\$10,500 respectively). ~55% of unit cost is steel and materials; the labor share is ~3× higher than in the Turkey model because US labor (\$30/hr fully loaded) is significantly more expensive.

## 6. PRICING AND REVENUE

### Competitive entry price (penetration)

- **Entry price: \$14,500/unit** — ~13% below regional custom competitors (~\$16,700). In the heavy-duty (6 mm floor / 4 mm wall) custom segment, the US price band is \$10,000–16,000; the entry price sits at the top of this band, below competitors.
- **Growth engine is volume, not price:** a competitive price starts market share and references; scale lowers unit cost. The regional producer advantage is defended with the "factory + freight" difference.
- **Normalization path:** Y2 \$15,000 → Y3 \$15,800 (gradual once brand and references settle).
- Options: rear door, custom size, corporate logo, custom paint → +\$350–900/unit.

**Sales channels:** Solid waste companies (WM, Republic Services, Waste Pro, regional players), municipalities and public tenders (Georgia 4% local production preference), construction/excavation contractors, co-selling with hooklift truck dealers, container rental companies.

## 7. 3-YEAR FINANCIAL PROJECTION

### Sales ramp (units/month)

- Year 1: Months 3–4: 15, months 5–6: 20, months 7–9: 30, months 10–12: 36 → **annual ≈ 268 units**
- Year 2: average ~42 units/month → **500 units**
- Year 3: average ~54 units/month → **650 units**

### Summary table

|            | Year 1 | Year 2 | Year 3 |
|------------|--------|--------|--------|
| Units sold | 268    | 500    | 650    |

|                      | Year 1       | Year 2       | Year 3       |
|----------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|
| Average price (\$)   | 14,500       | 15,000       | 15,800       |
| Revenue (\$M)        | <b>3.89</b>  | <b>7.50</b>  | <b>10.27</b> |
| Unit cash cost (\$)  | ~12,083      | ~11,520      | ~10,500      |
| Unit EBITDA (\$)     | ~2,417       | ~3,480       | ~5,300       |
| <b>EBITDA (\$M)</b>  | <b>0.65</b>  | <b>1.74</b>  | <b>3.45</b>  |
| <b>EBITDA margin</b> | <b>16.7%</b> | <b>23.2%</b> | <b>33.5%</b> |

## Investment and free cash flow (\$M)

|                                          | Year 1       | Year 2       | Year 3       |
|------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|
| EBITDA                                   | 0.65         | 1.74         | 3.45         |
| Corporate tax (~25%, incl. depreciation) | -0.13        | -0.39        | -0.77        |
| Investment (capex)                       | -1.30        | -0.35        | -1.72        |
| <b>Free cash flow</b>                    | <b>-0.78</b> | <b>+1.00</b> | <b>+0.96</b> |
| Cumulative free cash flow                | -0.78        | +0.22        | <b>+1.18</b> |

### Results:

- **Simple payback:** ~4 years (from production start; the investment is completed in Y4 at full capacity)
- **3-year cumulative free cash flow:** +\$1.18M (~35% of investment)
- **Cumulative cash return by end of Year 5:** ~2.0× investment
- **Project IRR:** ~15% in the 3-year window; rises to 25–30% at full capacity in Y4–Y5

Entry margin is ~17% (due to competitive entry price + US labor cost); scale, price normalization and automation lift it to ~34% by Y3. Margin rests on: (a) price discipline in the heavy-duty custom segment, (b) regional freight advantage, (c) reduced labor dependence through Phase 3 robotic welding. In a "selling price -15%" scenario, margin drops to ~2% (see sensitivity) — **price discipline is the primary criterion in the US model.**

## 8. SENSITIVITY ANALYSIS

| Scenario                   | EBITDA margin            | Payback estimate         |
|----------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Base                       | ~17% (entry) → ~34% (Y3) | ~4 years                 |
| Price -15%                 | ~2%                      | 6+ years (near negative) |
| Volume -25%                | ~12%                     | ~5.5 years               |
| Price -15% and volume -25% | Negative EBITDA          | Unsustainable            |

The model is most sensitive to **price**. Without customs protection in the US, price competition directly determines margin; a +20% steel price raises unit cost from ~\$12,354 to ~\$13,400 and must be protected by price adjustment (steel indexation clauses in contracts). Therefore, in the Georgia model, **staying in the heavy-duty/custom niche segment** and not cutting price for volume is critical.

## 9. STAFFING PLAN

| Phase   | Total | Direct (welding/assembly/paint) | Indirect (engineering/quality/sales/admin) |
|---------|-------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Phase 1 | 15    | 9                               | 6                                          |
| Phase 2 | 20    | 12                              | 8                                          |
| Phase 3 | 19    | 10                              | 9                                          |

### Phase 1 salary structure (steady 40 units/month — fully loaded employer cost)

| Position                                             | Staff    | Gross pay (≈ \$/month) | Fully loaded cost (\$/month) | Subtotal (\$/month) |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------|------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------|
| <b>Direct (9)</b>                                    |          |                        |                              |                     |
| Welder (MIG/MAG)                                     | 4        | ~3,980 (~\$23/hr)      | ~5,190 (~\$30/hr)            | 20,760              |
| Fitter / fabricator                                  | 3        | ~3,980 (~\$23/hr)      | ~5,190 (~\$30/hr)            | 15,570              |
| Painter (2K)                                         | 1        | ~3,980 (~\$23/hr)      | ~5,190 (~\$30/hr)            | 5,190               |
| Crane / assistant operator                           | 1        | ~3,990 (~\$23/hr)      | ~5,200 (~\$30/hr)            | 5,200               |
| <b>Direct subtotal</b>                               | <b>9</b> | —                      | —                            | <b>46,720</b>       |
| <b>Indirect (6)</b>                                  |          |                        |                              |                     |
| Quality control                                      | 1        | ~3,700                 | ~4,800                       | 4,800               |
| Drafting / CAD                                       | 1        | ~3,600                 | ~4,700                       | 4,700               |
| Sales / marketing                                    | 1        | ~3,500                 | ~4,500                       | 4,500               |
| Procurement / materials                              | 1        | ~3,500                 | ~4,500                       | 4,500               |
| Warehouse / logistics                                | 1        | ~3,300                 | ~4,300                       | 4,300               |
| Admin / accounting                                   | 1        | ~3,200                 | ~4,200                       | 4,200               |
| <b>Indirect subtotal</b>                             | <b>6</b> | —                      | —                            | <b>27,000</b>       |
| <b>Management / technical staff (outside the 15)</b> |          |                        |                              |                     |
| Plant / general manager                              | 1        | ~6,000                 | ~7,800                       | 7,800               |
| Quality / technical office manager                   | 1        | ~4,600                 | ~6,000                       | 6,000               |
| Process / machine engineer                           | 1        | ~3,630                 | ~4,720                       | 4,720               |
| <b>Management subtotal</b>                           | <b>3</b> | —                      | —                            | <b>18,520</b>       |

Fully loaded cost = gross × ~1.30 (employer FICA 7.65% + FUTA/SUTA ~3–6% + workers' comp ~8–12% + benefits). Welder/fitter gross ~\$23/hr → fully loaded ~\$30/hr (≈\$5,190/month at 173 hrs/month). This table feeds the Phase 1 unit cost lines **Direct labor \$1,168/unit** (46,720 ÷ 40), **Indirect labor \$675/unit** (27,000 ÷ 40) and **Management/technical staff \$463/unit** (18,520 ÷ 40). **Note — start-up phase pay:**

Management/technical salaries are deliberately set below market (US plant-manager gross average ≈ \$8,300–11,000/month vs. ~\$6,000 gross / ~\$7,800 fully loaded in the model). In a newly founded, owner-operated plant the founder works below market during the ramp-up and reinvests the difference; as volume and



profitability mature (Phase 2–3) pay is normalized to market. At full market cost, the management line rises from ~\$463 to ~\$740/unit and unit cost from ~\$12,354 to ~\$12,634, compressing the entry margin from ~17% to ~13% (at 40 units/month, ~\$14,500/unit revenue).

In Phase 2, direct staff rises from 9 to 12 (welders 4→6, +2 painters/operators) and indirect from 6 to 8. In Phase 3, welders drop from 6 to 2; a robot operator and a welding engineer are added → 19 total.

Welding starts in Phase 1 with **4 welders** — the customer portfolio realistically takes ~1 year to build and initial production is 15–20 units/month (no staff is hired for 40 units/month). In Phase 2, welders rise to 6 with volume. In Phase 3, robots take over welding labor and welders drop to **2**; one **robot operator** and a welding engineer are added → labor falls with robots while capacity rises to 55–60 units/month. The welder shortage is widespread in the US; robotization also reduces labor-supply risk.

## 10. IMPLEMENTATION TIMELINE

| Month | Step                                                                                                                |
|-------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1–2   | Company setup (LLC/C-Corp), building lease/fit-out, crane installation, equipment orders, initial hiring            |
| 3     | Portable cutting + fixtures commissioning, first prototype, customer approval                                       |
| 4–6   | Serial production start (15–20 units/month), sales network, quality system                                          |
| 7–12  | Ramp (15–36 units/month) · <b>Decision gate 1</b> (sales ≥ 30 units/month)                                          |
| 13–24 | <b>Phase 2:</b> CNC plasma commissioning, capacity 45 units/month · <b>Decision gate 2</b> (sales ≥ 45 units/month) |
| 25–30 | <b>Phase 3:</b> robot + positioner installation + commissioning                                                     |
| 30–36 | Full capacity 55–60 units/month + export start (Caribbean / Central America / Canada)                               |

## 11. RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

| Risk                                             | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------|--------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Demand below expectations                        | Medium     | High   | Phased investment; decision gate at each phase                                         |
| China/Mexico import competition                  | High       | Medium | No customs protection → focus on short lead time + custom + regional freight advantage |
| Price pressure (national manufacturers)          | High       | Medium | Niche heavy-duty segment; price discipline; no margin-cutting for volume               |
| Steel price increase                             | Medium     | Medium | Long-term supply agreements, scrap hedge, steel-indexed contracts                      |
| Skilled welder shortage                          | High       | Medium | In-house training (welding school programs) + robotization (Phase 3)                   |
| Workers' comp & product liability insurance cost | Medium     | Medium | Safety programs, quality documentation, insurance package negotiation                  |
| Working capital pressure                         | Medium     | Medium | Production synchronized with demand, terms management, equipment financing (SBA 7(a))  |

| Risk          | Likelihood | Impact | Mitigation                                                         |
|---------------|------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Quality/scrap | Low        | Medium | Fixture-based assembly, measurement/QC procedures, robotic welding |

## 12. INVESTOR VALUE PROPOSITION

1. **Low-risk start:** Production begins with \$1.30M; \$3.37M is not committed until demand is proven.
2. **Self-financing scale:** Later phases are financed from the current phase's cash flow; external borrowing needs are low (positive cumulative cash at end of Phase 2/Y2).
3. **Growing regional market:** Atlanta metro construction/excavation demand, the Port of Savannah (US 4th largest container port) and large-scale industrial investments (automotive, battery, solar) fuel waste and container demand in Georgia.
4. **Export base:** Container exports to the Caribbean, Central America and Canada via Savannah and Brunswick; shorter transit than national producers.
5. **Regional logistics advantage:** An empty container is heavy; the "factory + freight" difference favors a regional producer.
6. **Competitive entry, scaling margin:** ~17% entry margin (Y1) → ~34% normalized margin (Y3); ~4-year simple payback.
7. **Clear exit options:** Stop/downsize option at each phase; limited sunk risk.
8. **Tax and financing tools:** Federal 21% + Georgia 4.99% (effective ~25%); accelerated depreciation on manufacturing equipment (Section 179 / bonus depreciation) and SBA 7(a) equipment financing.

## 13. DISCLAIMER

All figures in this document are **estimates** based on publicly available US/Georgia market data as of August 2026 (steel prices, industrial rents, labor wages, tax rates). Actual results may differ based on demand, steel prices, competition and operational performance. This document is not investment advice; independent audit, local insurance/municipal permit review and legal review are recommended before a decision.